

Be Your Own Doctor

Natural Remedies for Common Ailments A–Z

by Joel Polley, RN

BraveWorks Health

NEWSTART Protocol Edition

DISCLAIMER

This book is designed to empower you with knowledge about natural remedies that you can use at home to manage common ailments and emergencies. Whether you're dealing with a minor burn, a headache, or simply want to boost your immune system naturally, this guide provides you with practical, easy-to-follow solutions that have been used for generations.

Before we dive into the world of natural remedies, it's important to note that this book is intended for educational purposes only. The information provided here is based on clinical nursing experience, traditional practices passed down through generations, and the NEWSTART protocol—a holistic approach emphasizing Nutrition, Exercise, Water, Sunlight, Temperance, Air, Rest, and Trust as the foundation of health.

However, it is not intended to replace professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment. You should always consult with a healthcare professional before starting any new treatment, especially if you have pre-existing medical conditions, are pregnant, nursing, or taking any medications. The remedies discussed in this book are meant to complement, not replace, conventional medical care.

If you or someone you care for experiences severe symptoms or an emergency, seek medical attention immediately.

By using this book, you acknowledge and agree that the author and publisher are not responsible for any adverse effects or consequences resulting from the use of the information provided. Each person's body is unique, and what works for one individual may not work for another. This book offers guidance based on personal experiences and traditional wisdom, but it is not a substitute for professional medical care.

Why This Book?

As a nurse and naturopath with 20 years of clinical experience, I have seen firsthand the power of natural remedies in promoting health and well-being. I have used many of the treatments described in this book on my own family, and I believe deeply in their ability to support the body's natural healing processes. However, I also recognize the importance of approaching health holistically, combining the best of both conventional and natural medicine.

In today's fast-paced world, many people are looking for ways to take control of their health, reduce their reliance on pharmaceuticals, and avoid unnecessary trips to the hospital or emergency room. This book aims to provide you with the tools and knowledge to do just that, all while being mindful of the limitations and responsibilities that come with self-care.

What You Will Learn

In this comprehensive A-to-Z guide, you will find detailed natural remedies for common ailments from allergies to zinc deficiency. Each entry includes clear symptoms, practical instructions for preparation and use, precise dosage guidance, and "Did You Know?" facts to educate you about how natural compounds work with your body.

From creating poultices and brewing herbal teas to understanding the benefits of contrast showers and mineral soaks, this book covers a broad spectrum of natural health practices grounded in the NEWSTART protocol. The remedies are easy to implement, using ingredients that you may already have in your kitchen or garden, or that are readily available through trusted suppliers.

Each remedy is organized by condition and remedy type, making it easy to reference what you need when you need it. Whether you're seeking support for acute discomfort or building long-term resilience, you'll find evidence-based, practical approaches to health from someone who has used and tested them.

A Journey Toward Self-Reliance

My goal with this book is to help you feel more confident and capable in managing your health naturally. While modern medicine has its place and should never be disregarded, there is immense value in the knowledge of natural healing methods. By integrating these practices into your daily life—rooted in the NEWSTART principles of whole-food nutrition, movement,

hydration, sunlight exposure, temperance, fresh air, restorative rest, and faith-based resilience—you can take a proactive approach to your health and well-being.

Thank you for embarking on this journey with me. I hope this book serves as a valuable resource in your pursuit of a healthier, more self-reliant lifestyle.

Sincerely,

Joel Polley, RN
Nurse and Naturopath

A

ALLERGIES

Symptoms: Sneezing, itching, watery eyes, congestion.

Natural Remedies:

ANXIETY

Symptoms: Restlessness, rapid heart rate, sweating, irritability.

Natural Remedies:

ARTHRITIS

Symptoms: Joint pain, stiffness, swelling.

Natural Remedies:

AS A NURSE AND NATUROPATH, I HAVE SEEN FIRSTHAND THE POWER OF

Symptoms: See remedies below.

Natural Remedies:

B

BACK PAIN

Symptoms: Muscle ache, shooting or stabbing pain, limited flexibility.

Natural Remedies:

BEE STINGS

Symptoms: Pain, swelling, redness.

Natural Remedies:

BURNS (MINOR)

Symptoms: Redness, swelling, pain, blistering (for more severe burns,

Natural Remedies:

C

CANKER SORES.

Symptoms: Small, painful ulcers inside the mouth.

Natural Remedies:

COLD (COMMON)

Symptoms: Sore throat, runny nose, congestion, cough.

Natural Remedies:

CONSTIPATION

Symptoms: Infrequent bowel movements, hard stools, abdominal pain.

Natural Remedies:

COUGH

Symptoms: Persistent, dry or productive (phlegm-producing) cough.

Natural Remedies:

CUTS AND SCRAPES (MINOR)

Symptoms: Skin breakage, bleeding, pain.

Natural Remedies:

D

DANDRUFF

Symptoms: Flaking of the scalp, often accompanied by itching.

Natural Remedies:

DIARRHEA

Symptoms: Loose, watery stools, abdominal cramps.

Natural Remedies:

DIZZINESS

Symptoms: Lightheadedness, feeling faint, loss of balance.

Natural Remedies:

DRY EYES

Symptoms: Irritation, redness, gritty sensation in the eyes.

Natural Remedies:

DRY SKIN

Symptoms: Rough, flaky, or itchy skin, often worse in cold or dry weather.

Natural Remedies:

E

EARACHE

Symptoms: Pain in the ear, often accompanied by fever or muffled hearing.

Natural Remedies:

EARWAX BUILDUP

Symptoms: Blocked ear, reduced hearing, discomfort in the ear.

Natural Remedies:

ECZEMA

Symptoms: Itchy, red, inflamed skin, often with blisters or scales.

Natural Remedies:

EDEMA (SWELLING)

Symptoms: Swelling in the legs, ankles, or other parts of the body, often due to

Natural Remedies:

EYE STRAIN

Symptoms: Sore, tired, burning, or itchy eyes, often from prolonged screen time.

Natural Remedies:

F

FATIGUE

Symptoms: Persistent tiredness, lack of energy, difficulty concentrating.

Natural Remedies:

FEVER

Symptoms: Elevated body temperature, sweating, chills, weakness.

Natural Remedies:

FLATULENCE (GAS)

Symptoms: Excessive gas in the digestive system, causing bloating, discomfort, and

Natural Remedies:

FLU

Symptoms: Fever, chills, body aches, fatigue, cough, sore throat.

Natural Remedies:



FLUID RETENTION.

Symptoms: See remedies below.

Natural Remedies:

F

FOOT ODOR

Symptoms: Unpleasant smell from the feet, often due to sweating or bacterial

Natural Remedies:

G

GALLSTONES

Symptoms: Sharp pain in the upper abdomen, nausea, vomiting, indigestion.

Natural Remedies:

GAS AND BLOATING

Symptoms: Abdominal discomfort, fullness, excessive gas.

Natural Remedies:

GINGIVITIS

Symptoms: Red, swollen, and bleeding gums, often due to plaque buildup.

Natural Remedies:

GOUT

Symptoms: Sudden, severe joint pain, usually in the big toe, along with redness and

Natural Remedies:

F

GROWTH.

Symptoms: See remedies below.

Natural Remedies:

G

GUM DISEASE (PERIODONTITIS)

Symptoms: Advanced gum inflammation, receding gums, loose teeth, bad breath.

Natural Remedies:



HEADACHE

Symptoms: Pain or discomfort in the head or neck, can range from mild to severe.

Natural Remedies:

C

HELPS TO STIMULATE BOWEL MOVEMENTS AND ALLEVIATE CONSTIPATION.

Symptoms: See remedies below.

Natural Remedies:



INDIGESTION

Symptoms: stomach discomfort, bloating, belching, heartburn, feeling uncomfortably full, nausea after eating.

Natural Remedies:

INFLAMMATION

Symptoms: redness, warmth, swelling, pain in joints or tissues, stiffness upon waking or after rest.

Natural Remedies:

INSECT BITES

Symptoms: itching, redness, swelling at bite site, sometimes localized pain or burning sensation.

Natural Remedies:

INSOMNIA

Symptoms: difficulty falling asleep, waking frequently at night, early morning awakening, non-restorative sleep, daytime fatigue or irritability.

Natural Remedies:

J

JOINT PAIN

Symptoms: aching, stiffness, swelling in joints (especially knees, hips, shoulders, hands), reduced range of motion, pain worse with movement or weather changes.

Natural Remedies:

K

KIDNEY STONES

Symptoms: severe back or lower abdominal pain (often sudden and unbearable), pain radiating to groin, painful urination, blood in urine, nausea.

Natural Remedies:

KNEE PAIN

Symptoms: aching, swelling, stiffness, difficulty bending or straightening the knee, knee feels unstable or "gives way," pain worse with stairs or prolonged standing.

Natural Remedies:



LEG CRAMPS

Symptoms: sudden, involuntary muscle tightening in the calf, thigh, or shin, usually at night or after exercise, lasting seconds to minutes, sometimes followed by soreness.

Natural Remedies:

LIVER SUPPORT

Symptoms: chronic fatigue, difficulty with digestion, poor nutrient absorption, sluggish metabolism, skin conditions (often related to detoxification burden), brain fog.

Natural Remedies:

LOW ENERGY

Symptoms: persistent fatigue despite adequate sleep, difficulty concentrating, lack of motivation, afternoon energy crashes, feeling sluggish upon waking.

Natural Remedies:

M

MENSTRUAL CRAMPS

Symptoms: lower abdominal pain, lower back pain, thigh pain, cramping intensity varies from mild to severe, may include bloating, fatigue, or mood changes.

Natural Remedies:

MIGRAINES

Symptoms: severe, throbbing head pain (often one-sided), sensitivity to light and sound, nausea, sometimes preceded by visual disturbances (aura), can last 4–72 hours.

Natural Remedies:

G

MOUTH AND IMPROVE GUM HEALTH, HELPING TO PREVENT AND TREAT GUM DISEASE.

Symptoms: See remedies below.

Natural Remedies:

M

MUSCLE PAIN

Symptoms: soreness 24–72 hours after exercise, localized or generalized muscle aches, stiffness, inflammation, reduced range of motion.

Natural Remedies:

N

NASAL CONGESTION

Symptoms: blocked nasal passages, stuffiness, difficulty breathing through nose, sometimes accompanied by sinus pressure or mild headache.

Natural Remedies:

NAUSEA

Symptoms: queasy feeling, sensation of wanting to vomit, lack of appetite, sometimes accompanied by dizziness or anxiety.

Natural Remedies:



OF CONTRAST SHOWERS, THIS BOOK COVERS A BROAD SPECTRUM OF

Symptoms: See remedies below.

Natural Remedies:

ORAL HEALTH & GUM DISEASE

Symptoms: red, swollen, or bleeding gums, tooth sensitivity, bad breath, loose teeth (advanced), pus pockets (advanced).

Natural Remedies:

OSTEOPOROSIS SUPPORT

Symptoms: no symptoms in early stages; later stages show increased fracture risk, loss of height, stooped posture, chronic bone pain.

Natural Remedies:

F

PASSING GAS.

Symptoms: See remedies below.

Natural Remedies:

P

POISON IVY & OAK

Symptoms: intense itching, red rash with fluid-filled blisters 12–72 hours after contact, rash spreads if not washed off, burns intensely when scratched.

Natural Remedies:

C

PROPERTIES THAT HELP RELIEVE COUGHS BY LOOSENING MUCUS AND REDUCING INFLAMMATION.

Symptoms: See remedies below.

Natural Remedies:

P

PROSTATE HEALTH

Symptoms: frequent urination (especially at night), weak urinary stream, difficulty starting urination, dribbling, incomplete emptying, urgency.

Natural Remedies:

PSORIASIS

Symptoms: red, thickened patches of skin with silvery scales, often on elbows, knees, scalp, or lower back, sometimes itching or burning, may crack or bleed.

Natural Remedies:

R

RESPIRATORY INFECTIONS

Symptoms: cough (dry or productive), congestion, sore throat, chest discomfort, sometimes fever, shortness of breath, fatigue.

Natural Remedies:

A

RESPONSIBLE FOR ALLERGY SYMPTOMS.

Symptoms: See remedies below.

Natural Remedies:

R

RINGWORM

Symptoms: circular, itchy rash with raised edges, often with clear center, can appear anywhere on skin, spreads easily if touched.

Natural Remedies:

B

SEEK MEDICAL ATTENTION).

Symptoms: See remedies below.

Natural Remedies:

S

SINUSITIS

Symptoms: nasal congestion, post-nasal drip, facial pressure or pain (especially over sinuses), headache, thick nasal discharge, reduced sense of smell, sometimes cough.

Natural Remedies:

SORE THROAT

Symptoms: throat pain or scratchiness, difficulty swallowing, redness or white patches in throat (sometimes), swollen tonsils, hoarseness, sometimes fever or swollen lymph nodes.

Natural Remedies:

STOMACH ULCERS

Symptoms: burning stomach pain (often relieved by food or antacids), nausea, vomiting blood (severe), black stools (severe), loss of appetite, bloating, belching.

Natural Remedies:

G

STONES FROM FORMING BY SUPPORTING BILE PRODUCTION AND FLOW.

Symptoms: See remedies below.

Natural Remedies:

S

STRESS

Symptoms: mental tension, physical tension (shoulders, neck, jaw), difficulty sleeping, irritability, difficulty concentrating, sense of overwhelm, sometimes physical symptoms like headache or stomach upset.

Natural Remedies:

SUNBURN

Symptoms: red, painful skin, swelling, blistering (severe cases), peeling skin 3–7 days later, sometimes fever or chills (severe).

Natural Remedies:

G

SWELLING.

Symptoms: See remedies below.

Natural Remedies:



TINNITUS

Symptoms: ringing, buzzing, whooshing, or hissing sound in ear(s), may be constant or intermittent, can affect one or both ears, sometimes associated with hearing loss or vertigo.

Natural Remedies:

TOENAIL FUNGUS

Symptoms: discolored toenail (yellow, brown, or white), thickened nail, crumbly or brittle texture, sometimes foul smell, nail may separate from nail bed.

Natural Remedies:

TOOTHACHE

Symptoms: sharp or throbbing tooth pain, pain with biting or hot/cold, swollen gums around tooth, sometimes swollen jaw or fever (if infected).

Natural Remedies:

U

URINARY TRACT INFECTIONS (UTI)

Symptoms: painful or burning urination, urgency and frequency of urination, cloudy or dark urine, sometimes lower abdominal or back pain, sometimes fever (if kidney infection).

Natural Remedies:



VARICOSE VEINS

Symptoms: enlarged, twisted veins (usually in legs), visible bulges under skin, pain, heaviness, swelling, skin discoloration near affected veins.

Natural Remedies:

VERTIGO

Symptoms: sensation of spinning (room spinning or feeling of movement), dizziness, loss of balance, nausea, sometimes vomiting, symptoms may be triggered by head position changes.

Natural Remedies:

W

WARTS

Symptoms: small, hard growths on skin (usually hands or feet), flesh-colored or slightly darker, may have a bumpy surface, can be single or multiple, often painless unless on pressure-bearing areas.

Natural Remedies:

WOUND HEALING

Symptoms: skin damage with potential bleeding, open or closed wounds, goal is rapid healing with minimal scarring and low infection risk.

Natural Remedies:

Y

YEAST INFECTIONS

Symptoms: vaginal itching or burning, thick white discharge (cottage cheese-like), burning during urination or intercourse, sometimes external redness or swelling, odor may be present.

Natural Remedies:

Z

ZINC DEFICIENCY

Symptoms: slow wound healing, increased infections, hair loss, weak immune function, poor appetite, skin issues, difficulty tasting food, age-related macular degeneration risk (severe deficiency).

Natural Remedies:

APPENDIX: Safe Storage & Dosing Guidelines

Herbal Preparations Storage:

- **Dried herbs:** Store in airtight glass containers away from light, heat, and moisture. Shelf life 1–2 years.
- **Infusions & decoctions:** Refrigerate in glass containers for up to 5 days.
- **Oils & extracts:** Store in dark glass bottles in a cool location for up to 1 year.
- **Fresh preparations:** Use immediately or within 24 hours.

Safety Reminders:

- Always use clean equipment and filtered water.
- Label all preparations with contents and date made.
- When in doubt about a remedy, consult a licensed healthcare provider.
- Children, pregnant people, and those on medications require professional guidance before using herbal remedies.
- If symptoms worsen despite natural treatment, or if fever develops, seek professional medical attention immediately.

About the NEWSTART Protocol:

The remedies in this book are grounded in the NEWSTART protocol—a comprehensive natural health approach emphasizing eight fundamental pillars:

- **Nutrition:** Whole, plant-based foods providing the building blocks for health
- **Exercise:** Regular movement supporting circulation, strength, and mental health
- **Water:** Pure hydration for cellular function and natural detoxification
- **Sunlight:** Natural light exposure for vitamin D, circadian rhythm, and mood
- **Temperance:** Moderation and balance in all things
- **Air:** Fresh air, deep breathing, and clean environment
- **Rest:** Restorative sleep and recovery essential for healing
- **Trust:** Faith, purpose, and positive mental outlook

When these eight pillars are in place, the body's natural healing capacity is optimized, and natural remedies work most effectively.

About the Author

Joel Polley, RN is a registered nurse with more than 20 years of experience in intensive care and emergency medicine. During his clinical career, he witnessed both the power and limitations of conventional medicine, which inspired him to deepen his knowledge of natural healing practices and naturopathic principles.

Joel is a certified naturopathic practitioner and founder of **BraveWorks Health**, an organization dedicated to empowering individuals with evidence-based natural health knowledge and practical tools for self-care. He is passionate about bridging the gap between conventional and natural medicine, helping people take active roles in their own health and healing.

When not writing or consulting, Joel works with individuals and families seeking to optimize their health through the NEWSTART protocol and evidence-based natural remedies. He believes that true health comes from understanding how the body heals naturally when supported with proper nutrition, movement, rest, and intention.